

Continuous writing: Creative Writing

Creative writing refers to the literary work produced by a student himself. It can be a short story, a drama piece or a poem.

A question like “write a story which ends with the saying “one good turn deserves another”. “All that glitters is not gold” “oh had I known” demands a short story writing.

Short stories are meant to be centered around proverbial themes. Here, you are required to weave a story that would illustrate the truth of the proverb.

Features of a short story.

1. Theme: A short story must have a central point from which a story is developed.
Examples “A bird in the hand is worth two in the bush”. Uneasy lies the head that wears the crown.
2. Plot: It must have a storyline. This means the order the story follows to develop the theme. The plot of a bird in the hand is worth two in the bush must feature a good character that uses opportunity as it comes to better life other than waiting for an opportunity that he has not seen or losing an opportunity he has because of the one he has not seen.
3. Characters: The story must show who and who took part in the actions or events of the story. The story will be real if you give the characters names and show interaction among them through the use of dialogue.
4. Setting: The story must tell its readers where and when the events or actions took place.
5. The story must have a beginning, a climax, an anti-climax and a conclusion.
6. Language:
 - i. The tense of the narration must be past tense but when dialogue is brought in, the tense can be present.
 - ii. The use of dialogue, humour, anecdotes, rhetorical questions will certainly bring the characters to life and enrich the story.
 - iii. The narration can be in the 1st person (I, we) or 3rd person (he, she, they)
 - iv. Use imagery that appeals to the senses in descriptive portions of your story. Example “The car screeched to a halt and three hefty fierce looking men jumped out of it. I held my breath. The underlined words created imageries which appealed to our senses.

Assignment

Write a story that ends with oh! Had I known.